

BEYOND THE CREST

Character Bible — Document 02

A Daytime Drama

Ages locked as of the premiere: Monday, January 5, 2026

Primary settings: Belmont Crest & Atlanta, Georgia

Ensemble: All characters in this document are African American

The World of the Show

Belmont Crest

A private, gated community of 1,240 wooded acres on a ridge above the Chattahoochee River at Atlanta's northwestern edge, inside the city limits. The main gate is at **1958 Belmont Crest Parkway NW, Atlanta, GA 30327**, about 8 miles from downtown, with Buckhead's Tuxedo Park just across the ridge. Alexander and Simone Donohue founded it on Saturday, May 17, 1958, when no Black family could buy land there, so they bought it through a white front. Today it is the most exclusive address in the South, home to the Donohues, the Bullocks, the Olsons, the Bakers, and the Cummingses. At the very top of the ridge sits **Summit House**, Victor and Joan's estate. Everything else in Belmont Crest lives *beyond the crest*. It also has its own country club, founded in 1961. See Document 04.

The Donohue Company

The largest multinational mass media and entertainment conglomerate on Earth. Alexander Donohue founded it on Monday, April 3, 1939, as *The Atlanta Beacon*, a Black newspaper. It grew into radio, “race films,” records, television, and eventually everything: Donohue Pictures, Donohue Broadcasting Group, Donohue Records, Donohue Publishing, Donohue streaming, theme parks, and live events. Headquartered at Donohue Tower in Midtown Atlanta. **Company valuation: \$10 trillion. Family fortune: over \$2.5 trillion.** See Document 03. The Donohues are the largest, most successful, powerful, influential, respected, beloved, charitable, and wealthiest family in the world.

Era	Leadership
1939 – 1976	Alexander Donohue, Founder & CEO
1976 – 2006	Alexander, Chairman • Victor, CEO
2006 – present	Victor, Chairman • Natasha, CEO • Marc-Anthony, Primary Heir Apparent

Family founders (deceased)

- **Alexander Donohue** (Friday, March 3, 1916 – Monday, January 9, 2006; died at 89). Founder of The Donohue Company and co-founder of Belmont Crest.
- **Simone Donohue (née Batiste)** (Monday, September 12, 1910 – Saturday, November 22, 2014; died at 104). A New Orleans-born jazz singer who bankrolled the first printing press, co-founded Belmont Crest, and was the family's first matriarch.

Aging note: “Black don't crack”

Every character's **age** is exact to their birthday. Every character's **look** is much younger. The “Looks” field below is the on-screen casting guide.

Master Age Ledger

Ages as of the premiere, **Monday, January 5, 2026**. Marc-Anthony turns 34 on premiere day.

Character	Born	Age on 1/5/2026	Looks	Next Birthday (turns)
Victor Donohue	Thu May 30, 1946	79	early 60s	Sat May 30, 2026 (80)
Joan Donohue	Sat Apr 17, 1948	77	mid-50s	Fri Apr 17, 2026 (78)
Alvin Donohue	Wed Oct 8, 1980	45	early 30s	Thu Oct 8, 2026 (46)
Theodore Donohue	Mon Jul 31, 1944	81	early 60s	Fri Jul 31, 2026 (82)
Congresswoman Jasmine Olson	Mon Mar 23, 1970	55	about 40	Mon Mar 23, 2026 (56)
Dr. Peter Olson	Thu Nov 13, 1969	56	early 40s	Fri Nov 13, 2026 (57)
Martin Olson	Wed May 15, 1991	34	late 20s	Fri May 15, 2026 (35)
Mallory Olson	Mon Jun 5, 1995	30	early 20s	Fri Jun 5, 2026 (31)
Robert Bullock	Tue Feb 10, 1959	66	late 40s	Tue Feb 10, 2026 (67)
Natasha Bullock	Wed Jun 2, 1971	54	late 30s	Tue Jun 2, 2026 (55)
Chief Elxa Jackson	Wed Aug 29, 1990	35	mid-20s	Sat Aug 29, 2026 (36)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	Sun Jan 5, 1992	34	mid-20s	Mon Jan 5, 2026 (34)
Grace Bullock	Tue Apr 12, 1994	31	early 20s	Sun Apr 12, 2026 (32)
Amond Baker	Mon Feb 10, 1992	33	mid-20s	Tue Feb 10, 2026 (34)
Arianna Cummings	Sun Oct 25, 1992	33	mid-20s	Sun Oct 25, 2026 (34)
Esther Smilley	Sun Sep 20, 1992	33	early 20s	Sun Sep 20, 2026 (34)
Harmony Divine	Fri Jun 19, 1992	33	mid-20s	Fri Jun 19, 2026 (34)
Detective Jeremy Jackson	Sun Dec 2, 1990	35	late 20s	Wed Dec 2, 2026 (36)
Emma Smilley	Thu May 10, 2012	13	13	Sun May 10, 2026 (14)
Victoria Smilley	Thu May 10, 2012	13	13	Sun May 10, 2026 (14)
Lyric Solace Baker	Fri Apr 20, 2012	13	13	Mon Apr 20, 2026 (14)

THE DONOHUE FAMILY

VICTOR DONOHUE

Born: Thursday, May 30, 1946 • **Age:** 79 • **Looks:** early 60s

Title: Chairman, The Donohue Company (2006–present) • Former CEO (1976–2006) • Retired actor, singer, director & producer • EGOT

Ties: Youngest son of Alexander & Simone Donohue • Husband of Joan (m. Sat, June 14, 1969) • Father of Jasmine, Natasha & Alvin • Younger brother of Theodore

The King of Belmont Crest. Victor is velvet over steel: a warm baritone laugh, a perfectly knotted tie, and a memory that never forgets a debt or a slight. He is beloved in public and feared in private. He has buried rivals in boardrooms for fifty years without raising his voice, and the one time he did raise it, a network changed hands by Monday.

Backstory

- Born in Atlanta while his father was turning *The Atlanta Beacon*, a Black newspaper, into a media house. Raised between the newsroom, the radio booth, and the family's first soundstage.
- Became a matinee idol in the 1960s through Donohue Pictures, then a Broadway leading man who could sing the rafters down. He isn't a professional singer, but his Grammy for a Broadway cast album completed the EGOT.
- Married Joan Mercer, his co-star, on Saturday, June 14, 1969. It is still the most photographed wedding in Donohue history.
- On Monday, January 5, 1976, his father made him CEO over his older brother Theodore. Theodore has never forgiven either of them.
- Over thirty years as CEO he built The Donohue Company into the largest media and entertainment conglomerate on Earth. He became Chairman after Alexander died on Monday, January 9, 2006, and handed the CEO chair to Natasha.
- Personally named his grandson Marc-Anthony as heir apparent. That decision split the third generation in two.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Knows more about everyone's sins than anyone alive, and keeps the files.
- The 1976 succession wasn't only merit. What Alexander knew about Theodore that day is a buried family secret.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

VICTOR

I don't make threats, son. Threats are for men who might not follow through.

JOAN DONOHUE (née MERCER)

Born: Saturday, April 17, 1948 • **Age:** 77 • **Looks:** mid-50s

Title: Philanthropist • Chair, The Donohue Foundation • Retired actress, singer, director & producer • EGOT

Ties: Wife of Victor (m. 1969) • Mother of Jasmine, Natasha & Alvin

The Queen Mother. Joan is grace, discipline, and a gaze that can end a conversation. She runs the Donohue Foundation, which spares no expense, the way a general runs a campaign. Nothing happens at Summit House without her knowing, and most of it happens because she decided it would.

Backstory

- Born in Macon, Georgia, the daughter of a Baptist choir director and a schoolteacher. She came to Atlanta at 17 with one suitcase and a voice.
- Discovered at a Donohue Pictures open call. Became Hollywood's first Black leading lady to headline a studio musical, and later directed and produced.
- Completed her EGOT with a Tony for a Broadway revival. She retired at the top of her game to devote herself to the Foundation.
- Holds the family together through every scandal. She is the only person Victor has never lied to, as far as she knows.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Keeps a private ledger of every grandchild's secrets. She suspects things about Marc-Anthony she has never said aloud.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

JOAN
(smiling, pouring tea)
Baby, I was ruining people's lives in heels
before your mama was born. Sit down.

ALVIN DONOHUE

Born: Wednesday, October 8, 1980 • **Age:** 45 • **Looks:** early 30s

Title: Entertainment power player • Political fixer • Party boy • Underworld-connected

Ties: Youngest son of Victor & Joan • Brother of Jasmine & Natasha • Uncle to the third generation

The Donohue wild card. Alvin is the life of every party from Buckhead to Monaco, and he can close a deal, a campaign fundraiser, or a back-room arrangement before last call. He's charming, reckless, and much smarter than the tabloids think. He is deeply connected in entertainment, in Georgia politics, and in Atlanta's underworld.

Backstory

- The “surprise” baby, born ten years after Jasmine. Spoiled by Joan, underestimated by Victor.

- Ran Donohue Records' A&R and nightlife ventures in his 20s. Built a web of clubs, promoters, and political donors that makes him the family's unofficial fixer.
- Has a string of relationships across three continents and famously never uses protection. Even Alvin doesn't know how many children he has, if any.

Secrets & Story Engines

- His underworld associates are rivals of The Blackwater Syndicate. He has no idea his nephew runs it.
- Every paternity claim that surfaces is a story engine. Any child of Alvin's is Donohue blood, with a potential claim on the trust.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

ALVIN
(raising a glass)
I'm not the black sheep of this family. I'm the
only one who admits he's in the pasture.

THEODORE DONOHUE

Born: Monday, July 31, 1944 • **Age:** 81 • **Looks:** early 60s

Title: Retired attorney • Former Fulton County District Attorney (1981–1996)

Ties: Eldest son of Alexander & Simone • Older brother of Victor • Great-uncle to the third generation

The Eldest Son Who Was Passed Over. Theodore is courtly and brilliant, with a prosecutor's instinct for weakness and a lifetime of favors owed to him in every courthouse in Georgia. He's corrupt to the bone and patient as a glacier.

Backstory

- Groomed as Alexander's heir, then passed over for Victor on January 5, 1976. He took the insult to the law instead.
- As Fulton County DA for fifteen years, he built a machine of judges, cops, and politicians who still owe him.
- Retired from private practice in 2015 but never retired from power.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Sees himself in Martin, the eldest grandson of the eldest child, passed over for the golden boy. He is quietly backing Martin's war for the throne.
- Holds the key to why Alexander chose Victor in 1976.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

THEODORE
History has a way of repeating itself, nephew. I
intend to see that this time it gets the ending
right.

THE OLSON FAMILY

CONGRESSWOMAN JASMINE OLSON (née DONOHUE)

Born: Monday, March 23, 1970 • **Age:** 55 • **Looks:** about 40

Title: U.S. Representative for Georgia (1997–present)

Ties: Eldest child of Victor & Joan • Wife of Dr. Peter Olson (m. Sat, June 16, 1990) • Mother of Martin & Mallory

The Firstborn. Jasmine won her seat at 26 and has held it for nearly thirty years. She is a legislative powerhouse who can whip votes, kill bills, and make cabinet secretaries sweat on C-SPAN. Deep down she believes the Donohue crown should have run through her, the eldest, and through her son.

Backstory

- Spelman College, then Georgetown Law. Married Peter, her college sweetheart, at 20. Martin was born the next spring.
- Suffered years of heartbreak trying to have a second child before Mallory, her miracle, arrived in 1995.
- Elected in November 1996 and sworn into Congress in January 1997. She has never lost a race.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Supports Martin's claim to the throne more than she admits to her father.
- Arianna Cummings's possible 2028 presidential run could collide with Jasmine's own ambitions.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

JASMINE

I have been first in this family since the day I was born. I don't intend to start finishing second now.

DR. PETER OLSON

Born: Thursday, November 13, 1969 • **Age:** 56 • **Looks:** early 40s

Title: Chief of Plastic Surgery, Atlanta Metropolitan Medical Center • Founder, Olson Facial Plastic & ENT Institute

Ties: Husband of Jasmine (m. 1990) • Father of Martin & Mallory

The Surgeon. He has steady hands, an ego to match, and a client list that could topple Hollywood if his files ever leaked. Peter is insanely wealthy in his own right, but he married into royalty and feels it every Sunday dinner.

Backstory

- Morehouse, then Johns Hopkins Medicine. Double-boarded in facial plastics and otolaryngology.
- Built the most exclusive private surgical practice in the Southeast. His patients include senators, stars, and people who officially never had work done.

Secrets & Story Engines

- His practice's confidential records are a gold mine every schemer in town wants.
- Dotes on Mallory, but his relationship with Martin is colder than anyone knows.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

PETER

Everybody in Atlanta has a face they show the world. I just know what's underneath it.

MARTIN OLSON

Born: Wednesday, May 15, 1991 • **Age:** 34 • **Looks:** late 20s

Title: President, Donohue Broadcasting Group • Self-declared rightful heir

Ties: Eldest child of Jasmine & Peter • Older brother of Mallory • Cousin and sworn enemy of Marc-Anthony

The Rival. Martin is the eldest grandson of the eldest child, and he never lets anyone forget it. He's polished, ice-cold, relentlessly ambitious, and astronomically deadly. He is also secretly trained in close combat and marksmanship, and rumor has it that two business rivals who crossed him simply stopped existing. He has never been charged with anything.

Backstory

- Harvard, then Wharton MBA. Rose fast inside The Donohue Company and now runs its broadcast network empire.
- Christmas Day, 2004, at Summit House: Victor raised a toast to Marc-Anthony as “the future of this family.” That night Martin, 13, shoved Marc, 12, down the grand staircase and broke his arm. It was ruled an accident. It wasn't.
- Has spent twenty years building allies, dossiers, and quiet leverage for the day he takes the crown.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Allied with Great-Uncle Theodore, and increasingly with Uncle Alvin.
- Obsessed with finding the one thing that can destroy Marc-Anthony. If he ever discovers Blackwater, the family goes to war.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

MARTIN

Birth order is the only law this family ever respected. I'm just here to enforce it.

MALLORY OLSON

Born: Monday, June 5, 1995 • **Age:** 30 • **Looks:** early 20s

Title: Office Manager, Olson Facial Plastic & ENT Institute • Entrepreneur-in-waiting

Ties: Youngest child of Jasmine & Peter • Younger sister of Martin • Cousin and future business partner of Grace

The Miracle Child. Mallory is brilliant, business-savvy, spoiled, and a certified daddy's girl. She runs her father's multimillion-dollar practice like a Swiss watch and is ready to prove she's more than Peter Olson's princess. She is a virgin by choice and by standard: nobody has ever been good enough.

Backstory

- Born after years of loss, and treated like a treasure ever since.
- Emory undergrad, then Goizueta MBA. Took over her father's office at 24 and doubled its revenue.
- Planning to launch HEIRLOOM, a luxury beauty & wellness brand, with her cousin Grace on June 5, 2026.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Caught between her brother's war and her love for her Bullock cousins.
- Her business will collide head-on with Smiley Beauty, and with Esther Smiley.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

MALLORY

I'm not spoiled. I'm appropriately appreciated.

THE BULLOCK FAMILY

ROBERT BULLOCK

Born: Tuesday, February 10, 1959 • **Age:** 66 • **Looks:** late 40s

Title: Founder & Managing Partner, Bullock & Associates, LLP (1995–present) • Criminal defense & entertainment attorney

Ties: Husband of Natasha (m. Sat, June 22, 1991) • Father of Elxa, Marc-Anthony & Grace • Son-in-law of Victor & Joan

The Shark. Robert gets the guilty acquitted and the famous richer, and he bills for both. He's astronomically corrupt, astronomically ruthless, and so charming that juries thank him on the way out. He is the only man in Atlanta who has stared down Victor Donohue and kept his job.

Backstory

- Raised in southwest Atlanta by a single mother who cleaned offices on Peachtree. Clark College, then Howard Law, on scholarship and spite.
- Met Natasha when she was 18 and he was 30. Their relationship scandalized the Donohues. Elxa was born in August 1990, and he married Natasha in June 1991 while she was pregnant with

Marc-Anthony. Victor still calls it “the hostile takeover.”

- Opened Bullock & Associates on Wednesday, March 1, 1995. Today it is the most feared defense and entertainment firm in America.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Has quietly represented people connected to Blackwater without knowing who's at the top.
- Knows where some of Theodore's bodies are buried, literally and figuratively.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

ROBERT
Innocent costs extra.

NATASHA BULLOCK (née DONOHUE)

Born: Wednesday, June 2, 1971 • **Age:** 54 • **Looks:** late 30s

Title: CEO, The Donohue Company (2006–present) • Actress, singer & producer • One award short of an EGOT (missing the Oscar)

Ties: Middle child of Victor & Joan • Wife of Robert (m. 1991) • Mother of Elxa, Marc-Anthony & Grace

The Queen Regent. Natasha is a movie star who became the most powerful CEO in the world, and she never stopped performing. She's ruthless, dangerous, and gleefully willing to bend any rule that stands between her family and what it deserves. Marc-Anthony got his rule-bending from her, and she's proud of it.

Backstory

- Child star turned leading lady. Won the Emmy, Grammy, and Tony, and has three Oscar nominations and no Oscar.
- Chose Robert over her father's wishes, and has spent 35 years proving she was right.
- Named CEO in January 2006 after Alexander's death. She has since tripled the company's value.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Suspects Marc-Anthony has a second life. She has chosen not to ask.
- Is grooming Marc to succeed her, which makes her Jasmine's rival as well as her sister.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

NATASHA
Rules are just suggestions written by people who were scared of me.

CHIEF ELXA JACKSON (née BULLOCK)

Born: Wednesday, August 29, 1990 • **Age:** 35 • **Looks:** mid-20s

Title: Chief of Police, Atlanta Police Department (appointed Tue, September 2, 2025) • Former Lieutenant, Homicide

Ties: Eldest child of Robert & Natasha • Older sister of Marc-Anthony & Grace • Wife of Det. Jeremy Jackson (m. Sat, June 15, 2024)

The Top Cop. Elxa is the eldest grandchild, and she walked away from the Donohue throne to carry a badge. She's formidable, fearless, and about 25% by the book and 75% not. She closes cases her way and dares anyone to prove she cut a corner. She's more like her little brother than she'll ever admit.

Backstory

- Born before her parents married, which the Donohues still don't discuss at dinner.
- Spelman, then Georgia State (criminal justice). Joined APD at 22. Made homicide detective at 27 and lieutenant at 31, with the highest clearance rate in the department's history.
- Became Atlanta's youngest-ever Chief of Police at 35.
- Wants children badly. Every time she brings it up, Jeremy finds a reason not to talk about it.

Secrets & Story Engines

- As a homicide lieutenant she worked cases that left a mysterious pattern she privately called “the ghost network.” She has no idea it's her brother's Blackwater Syndicate.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

ELXA
I follow the rules. I just read them very, very creatively.

MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK

Born: Sunday, January 5, 1992 • **Age:** 34 • **Looks:** mid-20s

Title: Actor, singer, screenwriter, director & producer • One award short of an EGOT (missing the Tony) • Billionaire Heir & Primary Heir Apparent of the Donohue Family • **SECRET** Founder & Boss, The Blackwater Syndicate (2010–present)

Ties: Only son of Robert & Natasha • Younger brother of Elxa, older brother of Grace • Grandson & Golden Boy of Victor & Joan • Godfather & guardian of Lyric Solace Baker • Unknowing father of Emma & Victoria Smilley • Destined soulmate: Esther Smilley

The Golden Boy. Marc-Anthony is the sweetest, kindest, most loving, compassionate, innocent, and pure man in the world: the man who remembers the valet's kids' birthdays and cries at dog-food commercials. He's outgoing and magnetic, lights up every room and camera, and is gut-bustingly, unhinged, unfiltered-offensive funny. His reported IQ is 250. Hurt someone he loves, though, and the sweetest man in the world becomes the most dangerous one. He's a certified crash-out, Harry Potter and Percy Jackson times 2000. When a rule is unjust, unfair, or just plain stupid, he bends it, breaks it, or quietly rewrites it. **Personal net worth: over \$990 billion, rising every single day.**

Backstory

- Born Sunday, January 5, 1992, sixteen years to the day after his grandfather became CEO. Joan called it a sign. **The series premieres on his 34th birthday.**
- Made his screen debut at 6 in a Donohue Pictures family film. Skipped grades, graduated the Belmont Academy at 14, and finished Yale (film & theater, economics) at 17.
- Christmas 2004: Victor toasted him as “the future of this family.” That night Martin pushed him down the stairs. Marc has never forgotten.
- Summer 2010: a predatory developer and a ring of crooked officials destroyed Amond's family's business, and the courts shrugged. Marc, 18, took them apart in 90 days using money, intelligence, and pressure. On Saturday, September 18, 2010, he founded **The Blackwater Syndicate**. It grew into a 100% criminal organization, a true mafia with a code, and the largest criminal organization in the world. On October 3, 2011, he founded its legitimate twin, **Blackwater Security International (BSI)**. See Document 05.
- Saturday, September 3, 2011: at a Labor Day weekend party at a Lake Lanier estate, a very drunk 19-year-old Marc spent the night with a girl in a gold dress. He never learned her name and barely remembers the night. It was Esther Smilley.
- Awards: Emmy (Sun, Sept 18, 2016, Lead Actor, Limited Series); Tony nomination (Sun, June 10, 2018, lost); Grammy (Sun, Feb 10, 2019, Musical Theater Album for that same Broadway revival); Oscar (Sun, Mar 12, 2023, Best Original Screenplay, plus a Best Actor nomination). The Tony is the only thing between him and an EGOT.
- Friday, February 12, 2021: a sealed Fulton County family court order gave him temporary custody of his goddaughter Lyric. Five years later, he still has no explanation, and he isn't complaining.
- Built his personal fortune with early bets in tech, streaming, and AI, his trust, and Blackwater's reach. On paper, he's worth more than most nations.

The Dream: His number-one, ultimate dream is family: a big, gigantic family. Kids are non-negotiable. He believes in generational wealth. Kids adore him and he adores them. The cruelest irony in Belmont Crest is that two of the girls who raid his kitchen every weekend are his own daughters, and he has no idea.

Secrets & Story Engines

- **Blackwater.** Only the Table (his inner council, including Amond as underboss), Arianna (who keeps plausible deniability), and Grace (who'd hide a body for him) know. His sister the Chief of Police does not.
- **Emma & Victoria.** He has ZERO idea he is their father.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

MARC-ANTHONY
(warm smile, eyes gone cold)
I love everybody, man. That's the problem. You
touched somebody I love.

GRACE BULLOCK

Born: Tuesday, April 12, 1994 • **Age:** 31 • **Looks:** early 20s

Title: Actress & singer (Emmy & Tony winner) • Entrepreneur-in-waiting

Ties: Youngest child of Robert & Natasha • Younger sister of Elxa & Marc-Anthony • Cousin and future business partner of Mallory

The Baby Sister and Ride-or-Die. Grace is gorgeous, gifted, and fiercely loyal. She's the actress directors fight over and the sister who would hide a body for her brother without asking whose it was. She and Marc have been joined at the hip since she could walk.

Backstory

- Broadway at 19. Won the Tony at 23 and a Primetime Emmy at 27.
- Launching HEIRLOOM, a luxury beauty & wellness brand, with Mallory. It's her first venture outside the family business.

Secrets & Story Engines

- One of three people who know about Blackwater. She has already helped her brother at least once in ways her sister the Chief can never find out about.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

GRACE
Whatever it is, I don't want to know. Where's
the shovel?

THE CIRCLE

AMOND BAKER

Born: Monday, February 10, 1992 • **Age:** 33 • **Looks:** mid-20s

Title: Businessman on the rise • Marc-Anthony's best friend, brother & right hand • **SECRET** Underboss, The Blackwater Syndicate

Ties: Son of an upper-middle-class Belmont Crest family • Father of Lyric Solace Baker • On-and-off love of Harmony Divine • Shares a birthday with Robert Bullock

The Brother. Amond is loyal to the marrow and hungry to the bone. He wants what the Donohues have: respect, power, and the kind of money that makes rules optional. He's willing to become ruthless, dangerous, and corrupt to get it. His weakness is Harmony. He is genuinely, madly, deeply in love with a woman who breaks up with him every other season.

Backstory

- Best friends with Marc since kindergarten at the Belmont Academy.
- Watched his family nearly lose everything in 2010, and watched Marc save them. He has been Marc's right hand ever since.

- Became a father at 20 when Lyric was born. Since February 2021 his daughter has lived with Marc under a sealed court order, and Amond has never said why.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Knows more about why Marc got custody of Lyric than he admits.
- His ambition is starting to outgrow second place.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

AMOND

I'd take a bullet for him. I just want to own the building it happens in.

ARIANNA CUMMINGS

Born: Sunday, October 25, 1992 • **Age:** 33 • **Looks:** mid-20s

Title: Attorney General of Georgia (appointed Mon, March 17, 2025) • Former Fulton County District Attorney (2021–2025) • Possible 2028 presidential candidate

Ties: Daughter of an upper-class Belmont Crest family • Marc-Anthony's best friend, sister & right hand

The Prosecutor. Arianna is a political phenom, the youngest DA in Fulton County history and now the state's top law enforcement officer. She has a spotless public record, a camera-ready smile, and a spine of titanium. She is seriously weighing a run for president in 2028. She'd be 36 on Inauguration Day, constitutionally eligible.

Backstory

- Grew up three houses down from the Bullocks. She, Marc, and Amond were the Belmont Crest Three.
- Harvard Law at 22. Elected DA at 28. Appointed Attorney General at 32 when the sitting AG resigned in scandal.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Has skeletons in her closet that Marc helped her bury. The truth is sealed in the writers' room for a future arc.
- Knows Blackwater exists and chooses not to know details. That's plausible deniability, and it's also a time bomb for 2028.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

ARIANNA

I'm the law in Georgia, Marc. So whatever you're about to tell me, don't.

ESTHER SMILLEY

Born: Sunday, September 20, 1992 • **Age:** 33 • **Looks:** early 20s

Title: Billionaire Heiress • President & COO and designated heir, Smilley Corporation

Ties: Youngest of three children of the Smilley family • Mother of Emma & Victoria • Best friend and sister of Harmony Divine • Destined soulmate: Marc-Anthony Bullock

The Ice Queen. Widely called the most beautiful woman in the world, all natural, and 1000% ruthless and corrupt. Esther helps run Smilley Corporation, a consumer products, retail, and lifestyle empire, with surgical cruelty. Her grandfather Gus chose her, the baby, as heir over her older siblings, and she has been at war with them ever since.

Backstory

- Born in Manhattan. Raised in Buckhead's Tuxedo Park after the family moved to Atlanta in 1996. The Smilleys are new-ish money who resent Donohue old money.
- Met Harmony in 6th grade at the Westbrook Academy in 2003, when Harmony was the scholarship kid. They have been sisters ever since.
- Saturday, September 3, 2011: the Lake Lanier party. Drunk, 18, in a gold dress, she spent the night with Marc-Anthony Bullock. Twins, Emma and Victoria, were born Thursday, May 10, 2012.
- She chose to keep it secret. The official story is IVF with an anonymous sperm donor. It is a thin story for a 19-year-old heiress, and her siblings have never fully bought it.
- Has spent fourteen years avoiding Marc-Anthony. She skipped Lyric's christening and has turned down every gala he attends. All of Atlanta assumes she just can't stand him.

Secrets & Story Engines

- If her siblings prove the twins are Donohue blood, they will use it to strip her of the Smilley inheritance.
- Forbids the twins from working with Marc for one reason: up close, they look exactly like him.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

ESTHER

I don't hate Marc-Anthony Bullock. Hate requires proximity.

HARMONY DIVINE

Born: Friday, June 19, 1992 • **Age:** 33 • **Looks:** mid-20s

Title: Aspiring filmmaker, screenwriter & director

Ties: Daughter of a middle-class Atlanta family • Esther's best friend and sister • Mother of Lyric • On-and-off love of Amond Baker

The Dreamer Nobody Believes In. Harmony has the scripts, the vision, and the fire, and every door in town slams in her face. Her best friend is a billionaire, and her daughter's father's best friend is Hollywood royalty, but she refuses to be anybody's charity case. Her pride keeps her poor and her heart keeps her circling back to Amond. The toxicity in their on-and-off love comes mostly from her end.

Backstory

- Born on Juneteenth to a mail carrier and a nurse in southwest Atlanta. Scholarship kid at Westbrook Academy, where she met Esther.
- Had Lyric at 19 and dropped out of film school.
- In February 2021, under the sealed order, her daughter went to live with Marc-Anthony. She has never publicly said why.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Figured out years ago that the twins are Marc-Anthony's. She has never told Esther she knows.
- Secretly writes Atlanta's most-read gossip blog, *The Tea Kettle ATL*.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

HARMONY

Everybody in this town wants to discover talent.
Nobody wants to fund it.

DETECTIVE JEREMY JACKSON

Born: Sunday, December 2, 1990 • **Age:** 35 • **Looks:** late 20s

Title: Senior Detective, APD Homicide

Ties: Son of former APD Chief Walter Jackson • Husband of Chief Elxa Jackson (m. 2024)

The Boy Scout. Jeremy does everything 100% by the book. He's an honest cop, the son of a legend, and married to a woman who is his boss, his opposite, and the love of his life. Every time Elxa brings up children, he changes the subject.

Backstory

- Grew up in the shadow of his father, Chief Walter Jackson, and chose to be flawless rather than famous.
- Married Elxa on Saturday, June 15, 2024. Since September 2025 he reports up the chain to his own wife, a conflict-of-interest story waiting to happen.

Secrets & Story Engines

- The real reason he avoids the children conversation is sealed in the writers' room.
- Has quietly opened a file on an untraceable network behind a string of “justice” cases. He's hunting Blackwater, and his brother-in-law.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

JEREMY

The book exists for a reason, Elxa. Somebody has
to read it.

THE CHILDREN

EMMA SMILLEY

Born: Thursday, May 10, 2012 • **Age:** 13 • **Looks:** 13

Title: 8th grader, Westbrook Academy • Aspiring actress, singer & producer

Ties: Elder twin daughter of Esther Smilley and (secretly) Marc-Anthony Bullock • Twin sister of Victoria • Best friend of Lyric

The Elder Twin. Emma is respectful, responsible, organized, and fiercely talented, and she's a 1000% daddy's girl who doesn't know who her daddy is. Her talent, timing, charisma, and even her laugh are pure Marc-Anthony. Her favorite actor is Marc-Anthony Bullock, and her dream is for him to mentor and manage her. Her mother 100% forbids it and won't say why.

Backstory

- Raised as a Smilley on the IVF story. Through Lyric she became a fixture at “Uncle Marc's” house, and he spoils her and Victoria endlessly.
- Still knows the true meaning of hard work. She practices, rehearses, and plans.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Keeps a notebook of every way she's “just like” Marc-Anthony.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

EMMA
Mom says no. She just never says why. So I'm going to find out.

VICTORIA SMILLEY

Born: Thursday, May 10, 2012 • **Age:** 13 • **Looks:** 13

Title: 8th grader, Westbrook Academy • Aspiring actress, singer & director

Ties: Younger twin daughter of Esther Smilley and (secretly) Marc-Anthony Bullock • Twin sister of Emma • Best friend of Lyric

The Wild Child, contained. Victoria is respectful and responsible, but only just. She's bold, hilarious, unfiltered, and allergic to the word “no,” which is pure Marc-Anthony. She's a 1000% daddy's girl who wants her favorite actor to mentor and manage her. Her mother's ban only makes her want it more.

Backstory

- The twin who talks her way into trouble and out of it in the same sentence.
- Sneaks over to Marc's with Lyric more often than Esther knows.

Secrets & Story Engines

- She has already noticed that she and Emma look more like Uncle Marc than their own mother.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

VICTORIA

Technically Mom said don't *work* with him. She never said don't *visit*.

LYRIC SOLACE BAKER

Born: Friday, April 20, 2012 • **Age:** 13 • **Looks:** 13

Title: Working actress (2022–present) • 8th grader, Westbrook Academy

Ties: Daughter of Amond Baker & Harmony Divine • Goddaughter and ward of Marc-Anthony (custody since Feb 12, 2021) • Best friend of Emma & Victoria

The Angel. Lyric is a literal sweetheart: kind, gifted, gentle, and wise beyond 13. She's been a working actress since 2022 under the mentorship of her godfather, and she is the reason the Smilley twins keep ending up at Marc's.

Backstory

- Moved in with her godfather at 8 under the sealed custody order.
- Booked her first professional role in the spring of 2022; principal photography began Monday, June 6, 2022.

Secrets & Story Engines

- Might know more about why she lives with Uncle Marc than any adult realizes.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

LYRIC

Uncle Marc says family is who shows up. He always shows up.

Master Backstory Timeline

Date	Event
Mon, Sep 12, 1910	Simone Batiste born, New Orleans.
Fri, Mar 3, 1916	Alexander Donohue born, Auburn Avenue, Atlanta.
Mon, Apr 3, 1939	Alexander Donohue founds <i>The Atlanta Beacon</i> , the seed of The Donohue Company.
Mon, Jul 31, 1944	Theodore Donohue born.
Thu, May 30, 1946	Victor Donohue born.
Sat, May 17, 1958	Alexander & Simone found Belmont Crest.
Sat, Jun 17, 1961	Belmont Crest Country Club opens.
Sat, Apr 17, 1948	Joan Mercer born, Macon, GA.
Tue, Feb 10, 1959	Robert Bullock born.
Sat, Jun 14, 1969	Victor marries Joan Mercer.
Thu, Nov 13, 1969	Peter Olson born.
Mon, Mar 23, 1970	Jasmine Donohue born.
Wed, Jun 2, 1971	Natasha Donohue born.
Mon, Jan 5, 1976	Victor named CEO over Theodore.
Wed, Oct 8, 1980	Alvin Donohue born.
1981	Theodore becomes Fulton County DA (serves through 1996).
Sat, Jun 16, 1990	Jasmine marries Peter Olson.
Wed, Aug 29, 1990	Elxa Bullock born (before her parents marry).
Sun, Dec 2, 1990	Jeremy Jackson born.
Wed, May 15, 1991	Martin Olson born.
Sat, Jun 22, 1991	Natasha marries Robert Bullock.
Sun, Jan 5, 1992	Marc-Anthony Bullock born.
Mon, Feb 10, 1992	Amond Baker born.
Fri, Jun 19, 1992	Harmony Divine born.
Sun, Sep 20, 1992	Esther Smilley born.
Sun, Oct 25, 1992	Arianna Cummings born.
Tue, Apr 12, 1994	Grace Bullock born.
Wed, Mar 1, 1995	Bullock & Associates, LLP opens.
Mon, Jun 5, 1995	Mallory Olson born, the “miracle child.”
Jan 1997	Jasmine sworn into Congress at 26.

Date	Event
1998	Marc-Anthony's screen debut at 6.
2003	Esther & Harmony meet in 6th grade at Westbrook Academy.
Sat, Dec 25, 2004	Victor toasts Marc as heir; Martin pushes Marc down the stairs.
Mon, Jan 9, 2006	Alexander dies at 89. Victor becomes Chairman; Natasha becomes CEO.
2010 (summer)	Baker family business destroyed; Marc takes the conspirators apart.
Sat, Sep 18, 2010	Marc-Anthony, 18, founds The Blackwater Syndicate (SECRET).
Sat, Sep 3, 2011	Lake Lanier Labor Day party: Marc (19) & Esther (18).
Mon, Oct 3, 2011	Marc-Anthony, 19, founds Blackwater Security International (BSI).
Fri, Apr 20, 2012	Lyric Solace Baker born; Marc named godfather.
Thu, May 10, 2012	Emma & Victoria Smilley born; IVF cover story begins.
Sat, Nov 22, 2014	Simone Donohue dies at 104.
Sun, Sep 18, 2016	Marc wins his Emmy.
Sun, Jun 10, 2018	Marc nominated for a Tony; loses.
Sun, Feb 10, 2019	Marc wins his Grammy (Amond's 27th birthday).
Jan 2021	Arianna sworn in as Fulton County DA.
Fri, Feb 12, 2021	Sealed court order gives Marc temporary custody of Lyric.
Mon, Jun 6, 2022	Lyric begins her first professional shoot.
Sun, Mar 12, 2023	Marc wins his Oscar. One Tony short of an EGOT.
Sat, Jun 15, 2024	Elxa marries Jeremy Jackson.
Mon, Mar 17, 2025	Arianna appointed Georgia Attorney General.
Tue, Sep 2, 2025	Elxa sworn in as APD Chief of Police.
Mon, Jan 5, 2026	SERIES PREMIERE, Episode #0001. Marc-Anthony's 34th birthday.

Secrets Ledger: Who Knows What (as of 1/5/2026)

Secret	Knows	Does NOT know
Marc-Anthony runs Blackwater	Marc, the Table (incl. Amond), Arianna (no details), Grace	Everyone else, including Elxa. Jeremy is hunting it. Natasha suspects.
Marc is Emma & Victoria's father	Esther	Marc, the twins, the Smilleys, the Donohues. (Harmony and Loretta have figured it out and said nothing.)
Why Marc has custody of Lyric	Sealed; Amond & Harmony know	Marc, and everyone else
Arianna's buried skeletons	Arianna, Marc	Everyone else

Secret	Knows	Does NOT know
Why Jeremy avoids the children talk	Jeremy	Elxa, everyone else
Martin's staircase push (2004)	Martin, Marc	Officially an accident

Continuity Fixes Applied

- Jeremy Jackson's marriage year was listed as 2004. Locked as **2024** to match Elxa's profile. In 2004 they were both 13.
- “Natasha Donahue” is spelled **Donohue** throughout.
- Mallory is the daughter of Peter and Jasmine **Olson** (née Donohue).
- Elxa was born August 1990 and her parents married June 1991. That is kept as canon and used as a story point, since Elxa was born before the wedding.

Working Canon Adopted From Earlier Proposals

You didn't veto these, so Documents 03–09 use them. Say the word and any of them changes.

- **“Uncle Marc.”** The twins know Marc through Lyric and he spoils them endlessly without knowing why he feels so connected to them.
- **Harmony knows about the twins**, and has never told Esther she knows.
- **The Smilley family** is fully built out in Document 06.
- **Grace & Mallory's business** is HEIRLOOM, a luxury beauty & wellness brand in direct competition with Smilley Beauty.

Still Open

- **Lyric's custody.** The real reason stays sealed through Season 1 and is teased for Season 2. Recommendation: a 2021 crisis Amond and Harmony swore never to tell, with Harmony wanting the twins near their father as the hidden layer.
- **Jasmine's party affiliation.**